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Graduate Recruitment Team

Macquarie Group

Ropemaker Place, 28 Ropemaker Street

London EC2Y 9HD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Commodities and Global Markets Graduate Programme in London, with a particular interest in commodities, particularly energy. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Macquarie's recognition as Natural Gas/LNG House of the Year at the 2026 Energy Risk Awards matters to me because energy markets, and the currencies they move, are what my dissertation studies.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, tests whether governments that hedge oil change how their currencies react to OPEC news: whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make the oil beta smaller, kinked or one-sided, and whether any beta that remains can be traded after costs. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously: at the Strathclyde Poker Society, where I was Vice-President and then President, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their own win rate, variance and appetite for risk call for.

Macquarie's Commodities and Global Markets business stands out to me because it combines physical and financial expertise in gas, from the long-term LNG offtake agreements it signed with Texas LNG and AMIGO LNG in 2025 to the risk-management solutions it offers clients, and it was named Natural Gas/LNG House of the Year at the 2026 Energy Risk Awards. My dissertation tests whether a government's oil hedge changes how its currency trades OPEC news, and I would like to learn how Macquarie designs and prices the hedges its own clients rely on.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan